

4.2 Media Wars

In an ideal home theatre, the video aspect usually involves a large-screen or a high-definition television, or a projection system with a movie screen to project the image on.

In most cases, a projection TV is preferred; however, the astronomical cost of the television is the biggest hindrance. Most households substitute the projection or plasma television with their existing CRT television. Another option is to set up your home theatre with your personal computer acting as the media centre. With flat screens and LCD displays available in the market, the computer monitor is no longer a pariah in your entertainment centre. Of course, if you really are in the mood to splurge, you can go in for the 30-inch wide-angle display by Apple - running up expenses is not a very difficult thing!

A decently beefed-up computer can munch through large amounts of data without much trouble. A SoundBlaster card, a mid-level graphics card, and a 5.1 channel sound setup - and you have a decent media centre without going in for those big screen televisions or rear-projection televisions. The fact that your computer can do so much more than just let you watch movies or programmes makes it a very attractive alternative to a complete home theatre setup. Broadband Internet and media streams such as streaming video and Webcasts are a major reason as to why the computer would score over the television as the prime component of your

